

Your name:

The UK Linguistics Olympiad 2019

Round 2



Problem 2. Two Róng Don't Make a Right (10 marks)

According to legend, the *Lepcha* script was devised in the 13th century by Prince Chakdor Namgyal of Tibet. Today, it is still used to write the *Róng* (𑌶𑌟) language, which is spoken by around 50,000 people in Sikkim, India. Róng is distantly related to Tibetan, Burmese, and Chinese.

Below are some words (1-18) written in Lepcha script, followed by their transcriptions and meanings (A-R) in a different order. Note that *ó* and *ú* are distinct vowels from *o* and *u*.

1	𑌶𑌟𑌶	6	𑌶𑌟	11	𑌶	16	𑌶𑌟𑌶
2	𑌶𑌟	7	𑌶𑌟	12	𑌶	17	𑌶𑌟
3	𑌶𑌟	8	𑌶𑌟𑌶	13	𑌶𑌟	18	𑌶𑌟
4	𑌶𑌟	9	𑌶𑌟	14	𑌶𑌟		
5	𑌶𑌟	10	𑌶𑌟	15	𑌶𑌟		

A	<i>bakto</i>	'grain'	J	<i>lali</i>	'a kind of laurel tree'
B	<i>bi</i>	'vegetable'	K	<i>món</i>	'pig'
C	<i>bik</i>	'cow'	L	<i>radi</i>	'blanket'
D	<i>chik</i>	'to weigh'	M	<i>thúk</i>	'season'
E	<i>chung</i>	'little'	N	<i>tsung kóng</i>	'a kind of sorghum'
F	<i>dú</i>	'umbrella'	O	<i>tsúk</i>	'to bite'
G	<i>ka</i>	'overseer'	P	<i>ut</i>	'pig'
H	<i>kajú</i>	'dog'	Q	<i>úng</i>	'water'
I	<i>khek</i>	'freeze'	R	<i>út</i>	'otter'

Q.2.1. Determine the correct correspondences between 1-18 and A-R.

Q.2.2. Write in Lepcha: *chóng* 'hand', *jik* 'native land', *thikúng* 'great-grandfather'.

Q.2.3. Transcribe the following Róng words: 𑌶𑌟 'to crack', 𑌶𑌟 'to read', 𑌶𑌟 'elephant'.